

Shared Core and Divergence Zones in Honen and Shinran: A Three-Layer Exploratory Map of the *Senchakushu* and *Kyogyoshinsho*

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Translation note. The authoritative edition of this paper is the Japanese print/book edition. This English version is an AI-assisted translation prepared for access by English-language readers. It preserves Chinese titles, Taisho identifiers, and key Japanese terms where needed, but wording and nuance should be checked against the Japanese edition for citation or scholarly use.

Abstract

This paper is an exploratory study of how Honen's *Senchaku Hongan Nembutsu Shu* and Shinran's *Ken Jodo Shinjitsu Kyo Gyo Sho Monrui* overlap in semantic space, and where relative divergence zones appear after that overlap is established. The analysis uses a three-layer framework: a semantic layer, a lexical-thematic layer, and a source-marker layer. The lexical-thematic layer is not strict stylometry; it is implemented as dictionary-based counts of doctrinal and thematic word groups. This paper narrows the framework of the preceding Buddhist text embedding map [1] to Honen, Shinran, and Pure Land patriarchal anchors. The point is not to ask whether Honen and Shinran overlap, but what branches off after they overlap.

The nearest non-self neighbors of the 69 Honen chunks are Shinran in 50 cases, Daochuo in 11, Genshin in 4, Shandao in 3, and Tanluan in 1. The nearest non-self neighbors of the 191 Shinran chunks are distributed across Honen in 48 cases, Daochuo in 45, Genshin in 36, Tanluan in 23, Vasubandhu in 21, Shandao in 17, and Nagarjuna in 1. A 1000-iteration capped-20 subsampling check reduces the apparent Honen-to-Shinran concentration, but the broader tendency remains: Honen stays close to Shinran and Daochuo, while Shinran disperses across Daochuo, Honen, Vasubandhu, Tanluan, and other anchors.

When divergence from the shared core is compared, Honen-side candidates concentrate around right and miscellaneous practices, selection and rejection among practices, the Primal Vow, and entrustment or verification. Shinran-side candidates concentrate in the Shin and Keshindo fascicles, especially around shinjin and the three minds, sin and salvation, protective deities and cosmic order, critique of external teachings, and true / provisional sorting. The resulting hypothesis is that the difference between Honen and Shinran appears less as a difference in the meaning of nembutsu itself than as a difference in how the same nembutsu field is developed into forms of argument and source-based doctrinal architecture. This is a computationally derived exploratory result, not a replacement for historical, doctrinal, or citation-based scholarship.

Keywords: Honen, Shinran, *Senchaku Hongan Nembutsu Shu*, *Kyogyoshinsho*, shared core, divergence zones, semantic embeddings, three-layer analysis, SAT, source markers

1 Introduction

1.1 Position of This Paper

This paper follows the author's preceding study on three-layer maps of Buddhist texts [1], but narrows the target to Pure Land materials and especially to the relation between Honen and Shinran. The preceding study separated meaning, style/lexicon, and source markers in order to avoid treating semantic proximity, lexical similarity, and source relations as the same thing.

The central target texts are Honen's *Senchaku Hongan Nembutsu Shu* and Shinran's *Ken Jodo Shinjitsu Kyo Gyo Sho Monrui*. In this English version, these are also referred to as *Senchakushu* and *Kyogyoshinsho*. Since both texts address central Pure Land questions, a strong overlap in semantic space is expected. The important question is therefore not whether they overlap, but in what directions they differ after they overlap.

In this paper, a "divergence zone" means a textual region that appears relatively away from the shared core. It is a working term for relative protrusion, not a doctrinal or historical conclusion by itself.

1.2 Prior Research and the Position of This Study

The relationship between *Senchakushu* and *Kyogyoshinsho* has long been studied from doctrinal, intellectual-historical, and citation-based perspectives. Direct comparative studies include Moriwaki [3], Inaba [4], Umehara [5], and Asai [6]. More recently, Nezu has addressed the boundary between Honen's thought and Shinran's distinctive development [7]. This paper does not claim to discover the comparison itself.

Those prior studies can roughly be grouped into three concerns: direct comparison of the two texts, doctrinal systematization on the Shinran side, and citation or textual-source research. This paper does not replace those concerns. It asks instead where the full-text distribution and nearest-neighbor structure suggest that closer reading should be directed.

The purpose is therefore to re-place questions already accumulated in previous scholarship into a map of chunk distributions, nearest non-self neighbors, patriarchal anchors, word groups, and source markers. The expression "Shinran-side development" here is not a value judgment that Shinran completed something lacking in Honen. It refers only to a textual-distribution difference: in *Senchakushu*, the same nembutsu field appears as an argument for selecting nembutsu from among practices; in *Kyogyoshinsho*, it appears within a larger monrui structure of Primal Vow, shinjin, realization, true Buddha land, transformed land, patriarchal quotation, and true / provisional sorting.

Table1: Prior-research concerns and the perspective visualized here

Main concern in prior research	Typical question	What this paper visualizes
Direct comparison of <i>Senchakushu</i> and <i>Kyogyoshinsho</i>	How did Shinran receive exclusive nembutsu and the selected Vow?	The shared core and nearest non-self Primal neighbors of Honen and Shinran chunks.
Inheritance and development	How are Honen’s basic problems developed in Shinran?	Comparison of Honen-side and Shinran-side divergence zones.
Practice, shinjin, and Primal Vow transfer	How do the positions of nembutsu, practice, and shinjin change?	Word-group counts and the proximity zones of the Practice and Shin fascicles.
Patriarchal sources and quotation	Which patriarchal texts does Shinran use, and how?	Proximity to Nagarjuna, Vasubandhu, Tanluan, Daochuo, Shandao, and Genshin anchors.
True/provisional, expedient means, and transformed land	Where does Shinran’s systematization appear?	The Keshindo fascicle’s protrusion, Daochuo/Genshin proximity, and external-teaching or expedient-means word groups.

1.3 Research Questions

This paper asks three questions.

1. How far do Honen’s *Senchakushu* and Shinran’s *Kyogyoshinsho* overlap in a SAT Chinese-text embedding space, and in what directions do they separate?
2. How does Shinran’s spread relate to Pure Land patriarchal anchors such as Daochuo, Shandao, Genshin, Tanluan, Vasubandhu, and Nagarjuna?
3. When divergence from the shared core is compared, does Honen move toward the argument for selecting nembutsu, while Shinran moves toward a source-based architecture centered on the Shin and Keshindo fascicles?

The conclusion is not a doctrinal-historical claim. It is an exploratory result for extracting regions that should be examined against existing historical, doctrinal, and citation research.

2 Data

2.1 Target Texts

The central texts are Honen’s *Senchaku Hongan Nembutsu Shu* and Shinran’s *Ken Jodo Shinjitsu Kyo Gyo Sho Monrui*. Basic descriptions of *Senchakushu* were checked against Jodoshu reference materials [8], [10]. The analysis uses Chinese text acquired from the SAT Taisho Shinshu Daizokyo Text Database [2]. Pure Land patriarchal text anchors were added for Nagarjuna, Vasubandhu, Tanluan, Daochuo, Shandao, and Genshin.

Table2: Target texts and chunk counts

Type	Author	Work	SAT ID/range	Coverage	Chunks
Core	Honen	<i>Senchaku Hongan</i>	T2608	Complete	69
Core	Shinran	<i>Nembutsu Shu</i> <i>Ken Jodo Shinjitsu</i> <i>Kyo Gyo Sho Mon-rui</i>	T2646	Complete	191
Anchor	Nagarjuna	Chapter on Easy Practice	T1521, 0038a25–0040a22	Excerpt	6
Anchor	Vasubandhu	Verse on Aspiration for Birth	T1524	Complete	9
Anchor	Tanluan	Commentary on the Treatise on Birth	T1819	Complete	31
Anchor	Daochuo	<i>Anleji</i>	T1958	Complete	42
Anchor	Shandao	Commentary on the Contemplation Sutra	T1753	Complete	23
Anchor	Genshin	<i>Ojoyoshu</i>	T2682	Complete	73

These anchors are exploratory, not exhaustive representatives of all seven patriarchs in Shinran’s doctrinal tradition. Nagarjuna is represented by six chunks from the Chapter on Easy Practice, and Vasubandhu by nine chunks, whereas Genshin has seventy-three chunks. The number of candidate chunks therefore differs sharply across anchor groups.

2.2 Text Preparation and Quality Check

Text preparation extracted textual lines from SAT HTML and removed UI elements, HTML tags, image placeholders, and SAT line numbers embedded as interface material. Quality checks found 1644 SAT lines and 27246 non-space characters for Honen T2608, and 4215 SAT lines and 76030 non-space characters for Shinran T2646. Counts of actual replacement characters, HTML tags, HTML entities, image placeholders, button strings, and line-number contamination were all zero.

The earlier project used a method that decoded fixed-length token sequences directly. This paper checked that method against a Unicode-safe method. Replacement characters may appear at chunk boundaries in the older method, but embeddings of corresponding chunks remained highly similar and author centroids were nearly unchanged. The broad map in the earlier paper is therefore not rejected by this issue. Nevertheless, this paper uses token offset information and reconstructs chunks at Unicode character boundaries. The main chunking setting remains 700 tokens with 100-token overlap.

3 Method

3.1 Chunking and Embeddings

The text was tokenized with `tiktoken` and `cl100k_base`, then chunked into 700-token windows with 100-token overlap [13]. Chunk text was reconstructed at Unicode character boundaries, and each chunk was assigned a SAT line range, chunk number, and SHA-256 hash.

Embeddings were generated with OpenAI `text-embedding-3-large` [12]. Each vector analyzed here has 3072 dimensions. PCA was fitted on the Honen and Shinran chunks and used to project that 3072-dimensional space into two dimensions. The patriarchal anchors were then projected into the same fixed PCA plane. The two PCA axes explain approximately 11.6 percent of the variance, so the 2D figures are exploratory projections and must be read together with nearest-neighbor results in the original 3072-

dimensional space.

PCA is not the only possible projection method. UMAP, t-SNE, and MDS could show local neighborhoods or clusters differently. This paper uses PCA as the baseline display because its axes are linear, the same plane can be reused for anchors, and repeated runs are relatively stable. Robustness checks with other projections remain a methodological task.

3.2 Basic Three-Layer Design

The three layers are implemented as follows.

1. Semantic layer: cosine similarity in the 3072-dimensional `text-embedding-3-large` space, 2D PCA distance, author centroids, nearest non-self neighbors, and nearest anchors.
2. Lexical-thematic layer: dictionary-based word-group counts, including nembutsu / name, selection / Primal Vow, right / miscellaneous practices, abandoning / establishing, shinjin / three minds, vow / transfer, Name / true reality, birth / Pure Land, expedient means / transformed land, and sin / salvation.
3. Source-marker layer: dictionary counts of sutra names, treatise and commentary titles, patriarch names, and quotation-introduction markers.

The lexical-thematic layer keeps continuity with the preceding paper’s ”style/lexicon” terminology. In this implementation, however, it is not a strict stylometric measurement or translator attribution method. It is a proxy for local doctrinal and thematic density.

Table3: Outline of the word-group dictionary used in the lexical-thematic layer

Word group	Representative terms
nembutsu / name	念佛, 念仏, 稱名, 称名, 專念, 專念, 念佛三昧
selection / Primal Vow	選擇, 選択, 撰擇, 本願, 弘誓, 誓願, 第十八願
right / miscellaneous practices	正行, 雜行, 雜行, 二行, 諸行, 萬行, 万行, 餘行, 正定業
abandoning / establishing and selection	廢, 廢, 立, 捨, 闍, 拋, 傍, 取, 選取
shinjin / three minds	信, 信樂, 信樂, 三心, 至誠心, 深心, 眞實心, 一心
vow / transfer	願, 回向, 廻向, 往相, 還相, 利他, 欲生
Name / true reality	名號, 名号, 眞實, 真実, 金剛, 大利, 無上
birth / Pure Land	往生, 淨土, 浄土, 安樂, 安樂, 極樂, 極樂, 報土, 佛土
expedient means / transformed land	方便, 化身土, 眞門, 真門, 假, 仮, 邪, 外道
sin / salvation	五逆, 謗法, 闍提, 阿闍世, 提婆, 慚愧, 地獄, 煩惱

Table4: Outline of explicit marker dictionaries used in the source-marker layer

Marker group	Representative terms	Counting method and limitation
Sutra names	大經, 觀經, 阿彌陀經, 無量壽經, 涅槃經, 大集經, 日藏經, 月藏經, etc.	Counts explicit appearances in a chunk. Some variant forms are listed in the dictionary.
Treatise/commentary names	往生論, 往生論註, 安樂集, 觀經疏, 法事讚, 般舟讚, 往生要集	Counts only explicit work titles. Abbreviated or implicit references may be missed.
Patriarch names	龍樹, 天親, 曇鸞, 道綽, 善導, 源信, 源空, 法然, 光明寺	Counts explicit names. It does not distinguish quoted text from authorial exposition.
Quotation-introduction markers	云, 曰, 言, 釋, 疏, 論曰, 經言, 問曰, 答曰, 私云	Counts appearances. Some appearances may be ordinary usage rather than quotation introductions.

All word groups and markers are counted as appearances within a chunk. The method does not distinguish semantic polarity, context, quotation from exposition, or the standpoint of the quoted source.

3.3 Nearest-Neighbor Counts and Capped-20 Subsampling

For each chunk, cosine similarity was computed against all chunks outside the same target author group, and the group with the highest similarity was counted as the nearest non-self group. This simple count may be affected by the number of chunks in each reference group. For that reason, this paper also ran a 1000-iteration sensitivity check in which each reference group was capped at at most twenty sampled chunks, while groups smaller than twenty were used in full. The resulting ratios are shown as means and 95 percent ranges.

3.4 Protrusion Score

Honen-side and Shinran-side divergence candidates were extracted by combining isolation in the 2D PCA plane with weakness of the nearest non-self neighbor in the original space. For chunk i , let d_i be the distance to the nearest non-self chunk in the 2D PCA plane, and let s_i be the cosine similarity to the nearest non-self chunk in the 3072-dimensional space. The protrusion score is:

$$p_i = d_i(1 - s_i)$$

This score is an exploratory ranking index. Its absolute value has no independent meaning, and because it uses 2D PCA distance, it cannot prove high-dimensional structure or historical relations. A supplementary ranking using only high-dimensional isolation, $1 - s_i$, was also checked.

3.5 Fascicle and Chapter Labels

Shinran chunks were labeled by SAT line range as preface, Teaching, Practice, Shin, Realization, True Buddha Land, or Keshindo fascicle. Honen chunks were labeled approximately as preface, sacred path / Pure Land paths, right / miscellaneous practices, Primal Vow nembutsu, three grades and single-minded nembutsu, three minds and shinjin, entrustment / verification / selection conclusion, and final / colophon material. Because chunks overlap by 100 tokens, these labels are approximate and are based on chunk-start line positions.

4 Results

4.1 The Shared Core of Honen and Shinran

Figure 1 shows the semantic map of Honen and Shinran using SAT Chinese text and Unicode-safe chunks. PCA was fitted only on Honen and Shinran chunks, and the display range is adjusted to their distribution.

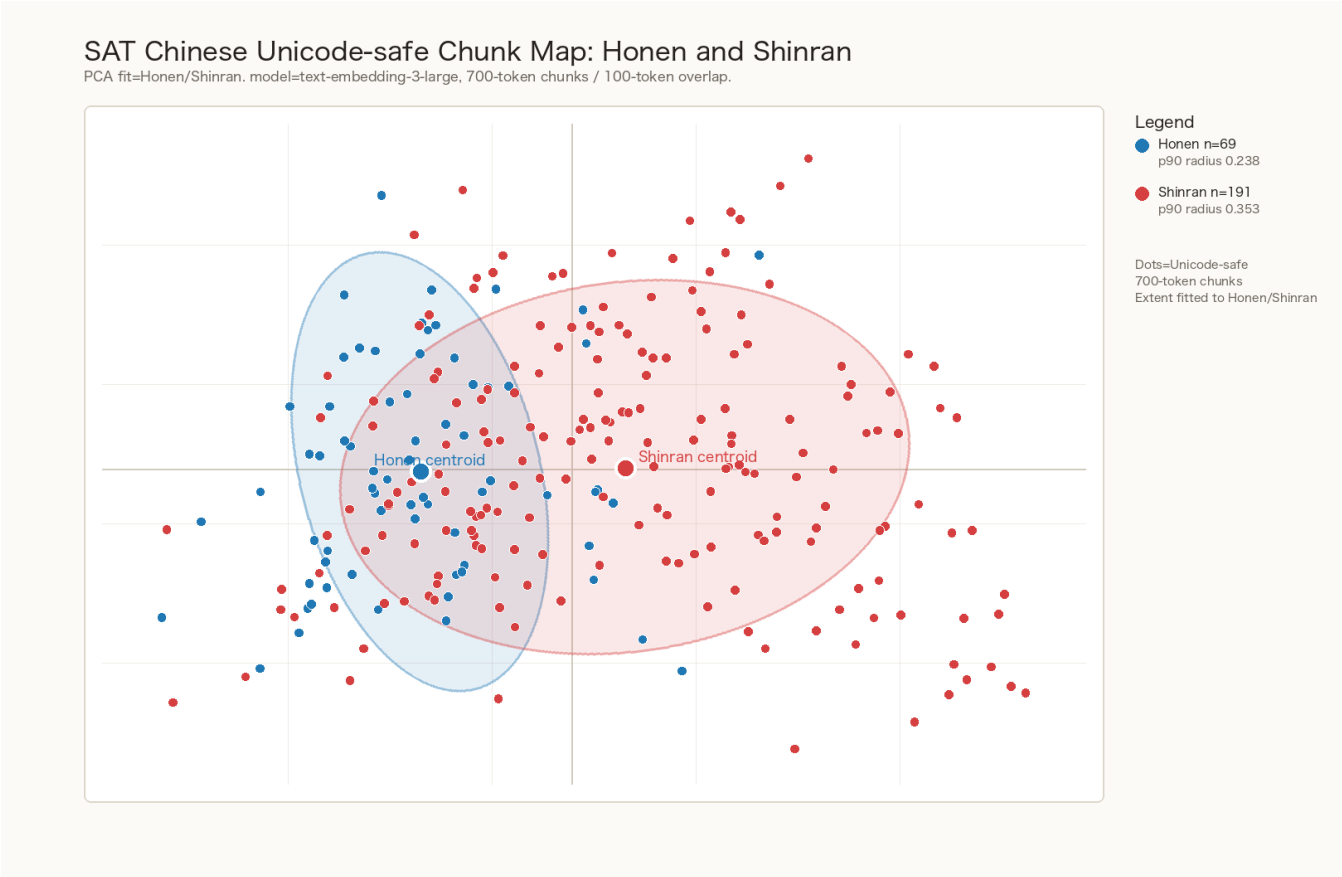


Figure1: Semantic map of Honen and Shinran using SAT Chinese text and Unicode-safe chunks. PCA was fitted on 69 Honen chunks and 191 Shinran chunks. The display range and ellipse definition are the same as the Honen/Shinran ellipses in Figure 2.

Honen and Shinran overlap substantially, but Shinran has a broader distribution. Honen forms a relatively compact distribution, while Shinran extends from the shared core toward the right and downward directions. This two-author map is the baseline for reading where the patriarchal anchors enter.

4.2 Patriarchal Anchors and Shinran’s Spread

Figure 2 projects Nagarjuna, Vasubandhu, Tanluan, Daochuo, Shandao, and Genshin into the same PCA plane. The PCA fitting target remains Honen and Shinran only. Adding the patriarchal texts adds their points and ellipses to the same plane; it does not recompute the Honen/Shinran ellipses.

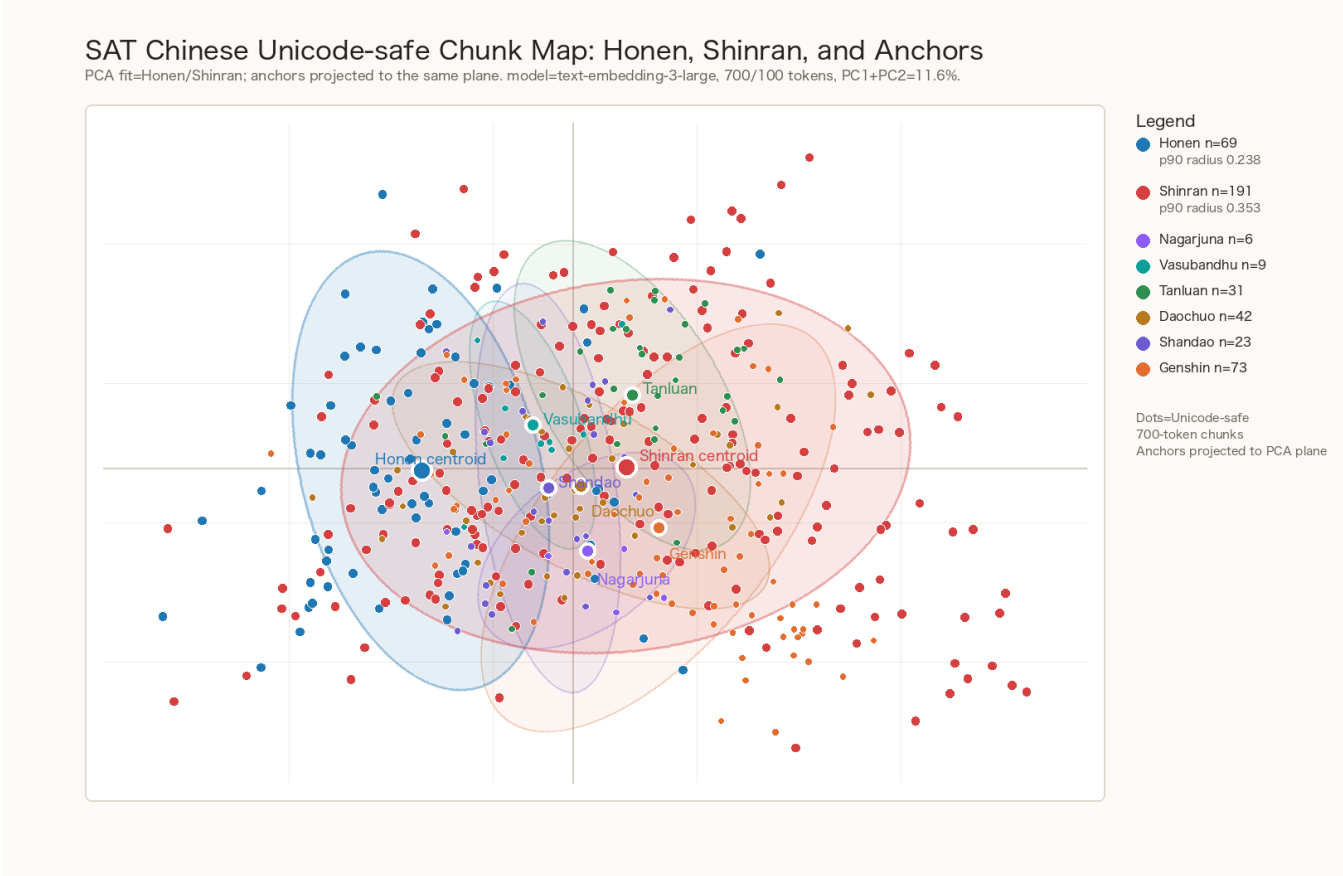


Figure2: Semantic map of Honen, Shinran, and Pure Land patriarchal anchors using SAT Chinese text and Unicode-safe chunks. The Honen/Shinran display range and ellipse definition are identical to Figure 1.

Daochuo and Shandao lie close to the shared core, while Genshin and Tanluan overlap more with Shinran’s broader distribution. The 2D display is then paired with nearest-neighbor counts in the original 3072-dimensional space.

4.3 Post-hoc Interpretation of 2D Directions

PCA axes do not carry doctrinal labels by themselves, and their signs may flip under recomputation. Therefore, the directions in the map must be read after the fact from chunks at the extremes: their fascicle or chapter labels, word groups, source markers, and high-frequency terms. Table 5 summarizes the approximate labels assigned from the outer 15/85 percentiles of the Honen/Shinran coordinates.

Table5: Approximate 2D direction labels based on PCA-endpoint aggregation

Direction	Main authors/fascicles or chapters	Frequent word groups	Approximate label
Right / PC1+	Shinran; Shin and Keshindo fascicles	sin / salvation; abandoning / establishing	Shinran expansion toward sin / salvation and transformed-land problems
Left / PC1-	Honen; right / miscellaneous practices, single-minded nembutsu, three minds	shinjin / three minds; birth / Pure Land; right / miscellaneous practices	selection argument and shared core
Up / PC2+	Shinran; Practice and True Buddha Land fascicles	vow / transfer; birth / Pure Land; nembutsu / name	Amida, light, Name, and vow-transfer direction
Down / PC2-	Shinran; Shin and Keshindo fascicles	shinjin / three minds; sin / salvation; expedient means / transformed land	shinjin / three minds, sin / salvation, and expedient / external-teaching direction

On this reading, the horizontal direction runs roughly from Honen-heavy selection argument and shared core on the left to Shinran’s Shin/Keshindo expansion on the right. The vertical direction roughly separates Amida, light, Name, and vow-transfer above from shinjin / three minds, sin / salvation, and expedient / external-teaching concerns below. This is only a description of the present PCA plane.

Table6: Summary of the shared core and divergence zones

Region	Computational sign	Main word groups/fascicles or chapters	Interpretation
Shared core	Honen and Shinran chunks are mutually close, and Daochuo/Shandao anchors also overlap.	nembutsu / name, birth / Land, shinjin / three minds	Pure A shared Pure Land problem field.
Honen divergence	Honen chunks move relatively away from non-Honen points and concentrate in selection-argument sections.	right / miscellaneous practices, three grades and single-minded nembutsu, Primal Vow nembutsu, entrustment / verification	An argument for selecting nembutsu from among other practices.
Shinran divergence	Shinran chunks move relatively away from non-Shinran points and concentrate in the Shin and Keshindo fascicles.	Shin fascicle, Keshindo fascicle, sin / salvation, expedient means / transformed land, abandoning / establishing	A source-based architecture of Primal Vow, shinjin, realization, true Buddha land, and transformed land.

Table 6 is the guiding summary for the result section. The following tables and figures test that tripartite reading through the semantic, lexical-thematic, and source-marker layers.

Table7: Nearest non-self groups for Honen chunks

Nearest group	Chunks
Shinran	50
Daochuo	11
Genshin	4
Shandao	3
Tanluan	1

Table8: Nearest non-self groups for Shinran chunks

Nearest group	Chunks
Honen	48
Daochuo	45
Genshin	36
Tanluan	23
Vasubandhu	21
Shandao	17
Nagarjuna	1

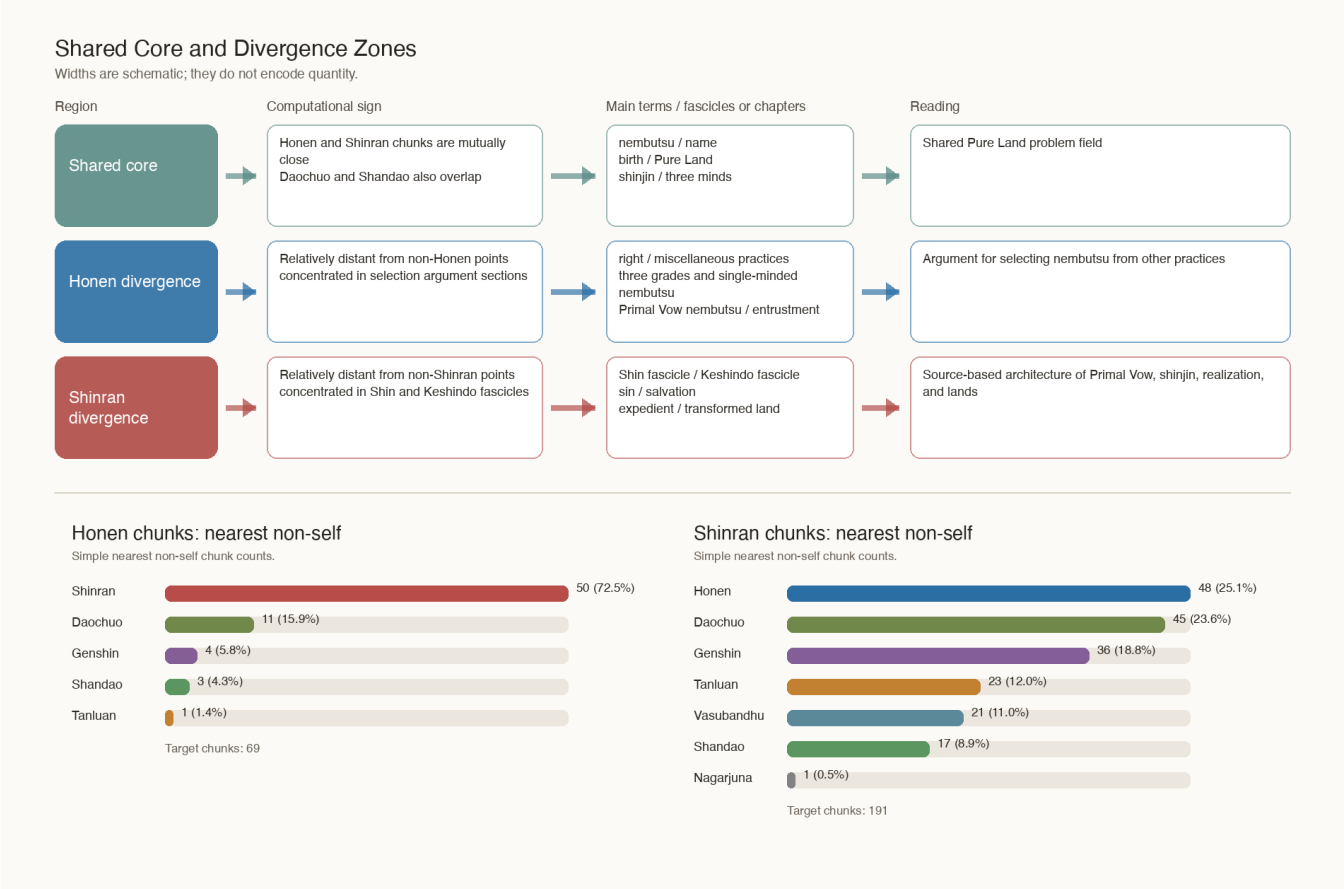


Figure3: Visualization of the shared core and divergence zones. The upper band schematizes Table 6 and does not encode quantity by width. The lower bars show the simple nearest non-self counts from Tables 7 and 8.

For Honen, 50 of 69 chunks take Shinran as the nearest non-self group. Under these data, chunking, and embedding settings, many Honen chunks are therefore strongly close to Shinran chunks in semantic space. This should not be read as a proof of influence or its direction; it is a semantic-neighborhood result.

For Shinran, nearest non-self neighbors are distributed across Honen, Daochuo, Genshin, Tanluan, Vasubandhu, Shandao, and Nagarjuna. Thus Shinran keeps a shared core with Honen while spreading toward several patriarchal directions.

Table9: Nearest-neighbor ratios under capped-20 subsampling

Target	Nearest group	Full/capped sample	Simple ratio	Capped-20 mean ratio (95% range)
Honen	Shinran	191/20	72.5%	33.9% (11.6–55.1%)
Honen	Daochuo	42/20	15.9%	27.2% (11.6–43.5%)
Honen	Shandao	23/20	4.3%	18.2% (10.1–27.5%)
Honen	Genshin	73/20	5.8%	15.7% (2.9–31.9%)
Shinran	Daochuo	42/20	23.6%	22.8% (15.2–29.3%)
Shinran	Honen	69/20	25.1%	19.0% (11.5–26.2%)
Shinran	Vasubandhu	9/9	11.0%	15.9% (13.1–19.4%)
Shinran	Tanluan	31/20	12.0%	14.4% (9.4–19.4%)

Table 9 shows that the simple Honen-to-Shinran nearest-neighbor ratio includes a chunk-count effect: it falls from 72.5 percent to a 33.9 percent mean when Shinran is capped at twenty sampled chunks. Even so, Honen remains oriented toward Shinran and Daochuo, while Shinran remains distributed across Daochuo, Honen, Vasubandhu, Tanluan, and others.

4.4 Shinran by Fascicle and Proximity Zone

Shinran chunks were grouped by fascicle and then classified by nearest non-self group and relative protrusion. The "Shinran-side protrusion candidate" label here does not mean doctrinal originality; it indicates places where, under the present analysis, proximity to non-Shinran chunks is relatively weak.

Table10: Major Shinran fascicle/proximity zones

Fascicle	Proximity zone	Chunks
Shin fascicle	Honen-proximate	21
Keshindo fascicle	Daochuo-proximate	19
Practice fascicle	Honen-proximate	14
Shin fascicle	Shinran-side protrusion candidate	13
Realization fascicle	Vasubandhu-proximate	11
Keshindo fascicle	Honen-proximate	10
Keshindo fascicle	Genshin-proximate	9
Shin fascicle	Genshin-proximate	8
True Buddha Land fascicle	Shandao-proximate	8
Practice fascicle	Genshin-proximate	8

The Shin fascicle includes both Honen-proximate chunks and Shinran-side protrusion candidates. The Keshindo fascicle mixes Daochuo, Genshin, Shandao, Honen, and Shinran-side protrusion candidates. This suggests a broad problem field including expedient means, the last age, external teachings, protective deities, and true / provisional sorting.

4.5 Honen Three-Layer Sequence: Convergence Toward the Selection Argument

Figure 4 places the 69 Honen chunks in textual order and stacks the semantic layer, lexical-thematic layer, and source-marker layer. The semantic layer shows maximum cosine similarity from each Honen chunk to Shinran and the patriarchal groups. The lexical-thematic and source-marker layers use the same dictionaries as the Shinran figure.

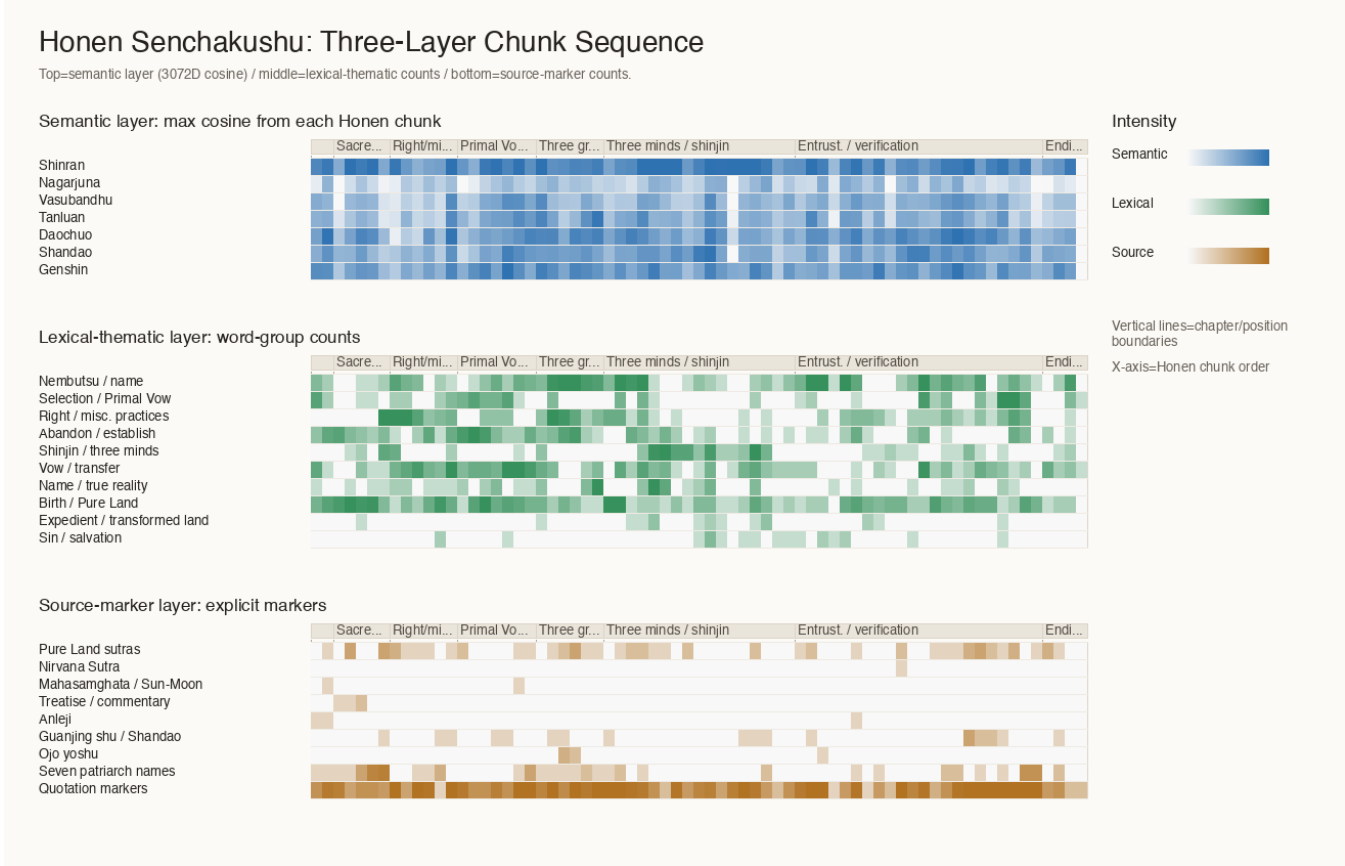


Figure4: Three-layer chunk sequence for Honen’s *Senchakushu*. The upper band is the semantic layer, the middle band is the lexical-thematic layer, and the lower band is the source-marker layer. The x-axis is Honen chunk order, and vertical lines mark approximate chapter or position boundaries based on SAT line ranges.

The semantic layer is frequently close to Shinran, while some locations incline toward Daochuo, Shandao, or Genshin. The lexical-thematic layer forms bands around right / miscellaneous practices, Primal Vow nembutsu, three grades and single-minded nembutsu, three minds / shinjin, and entrustment or verification. The source-marker layer shows strong quotation-introduction markers across the text. Honen’s sequence therefore appears as semantic overlap with Shinran combined with convergence toward the argument for selecting nembutsu.

4.6 Shinran Three-Layer Sequence: Expansion Toward a Source-Based Architecture

Figure 5 places the 191 Shinran chunks in textual order and stacks the same three layers. The semantic layer shows maximum cosine similarity from each Shinran chunk to Honen and the patriarchal groups. The source-marker layer counts explicit markers for the Pure Land sutras, other sutras, treatises, patriarchs, and quotation-introduction forms.

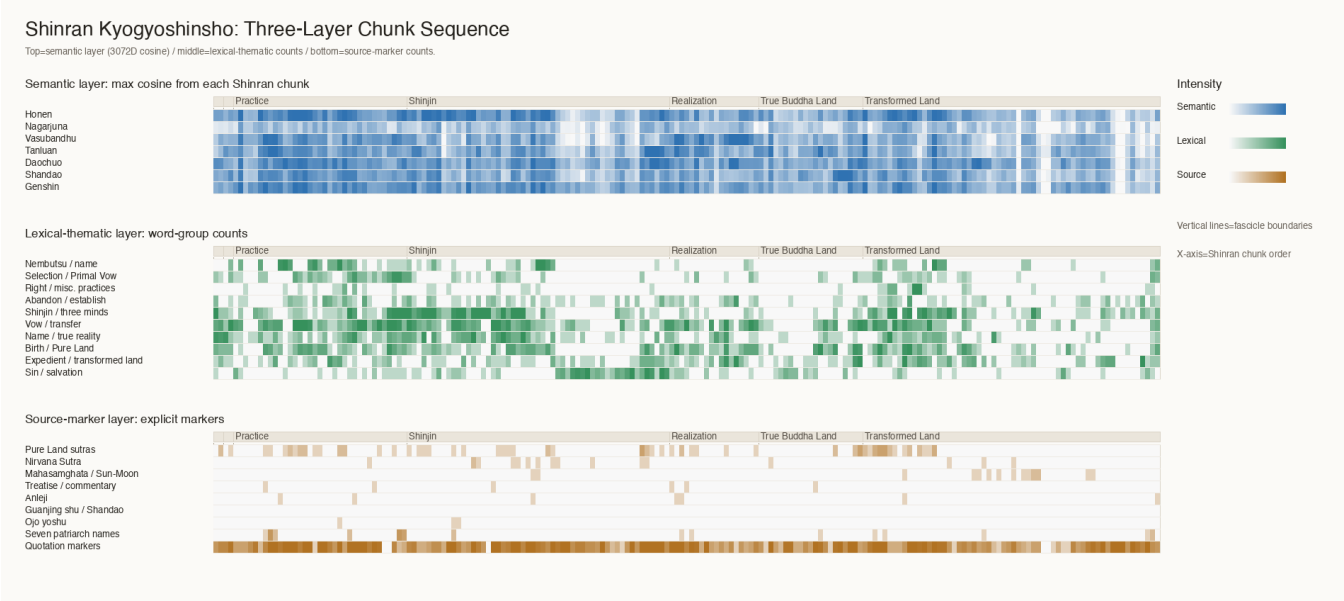


Figure5: Three-layer chunk sequence for Shinran’s *Kyogyoshinsho*. The upper band is the semantic layer, the middle band is the lexical-thematic layer, and the lower band is the source-marker layer. The x-axis is Shinran chunk order, and vertical lines mark fascicle boundaries.

In the Shin fascicle, semantic nearest neighbors divide among Honen, Genshin, and Daochuo, while the lexical-thematic layer emphasizes shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation. In the Keshindo fascicle, Daochuo, Honen, and Genshin proximity coexists with word groups for shinjin, vow / transfer, birth / Pure Land, expedient means, and abandoning / establishing. This shows why the three layers must be kept apart: semantic proximity, lexical density, and explicit source markers do not always move together.

4.7 Honen Divergence Zones

Honen-side divergence candidates were extracted by the protrusion score. Table 11 lists the top ten chunks.

Table11: Top Honen-side divergence chunks

No.	Position	Start line	Nearest	Nearest arch	patri- Word group
7	right / miscellaneous practices	T2608, 83.0003a04	Shinran	Shandao	right / miscellaneous practices
44	entrustment / ver- ification / selection conclusion	T2608, 83.0013b17	Shinran	Tanluan	nembutsu / name
22	three grades and single-minded nem- butsu	T2608, 83.0007b07	Shinran	Shandao	nembutsu / name
29	three minds / shinjin	T2608, 83.0009b05	Shinran	Tanluan	nembutsu / name
59	entrustment / ver- ification / selection conclusion	T2608, 83.0017c18	Daochuo	Daochuo	nembutsu / name
56	entrustment / ver- ification / selection conclusion	T2608, 83.0017a01	Shinran	Daochuo	nembutsu / name
15	Primal Vow nem- butsu	T2608, 83.0005b05	Shinran	Genshin	birth / Pure Land
37	three minds / shinjin	T2608, 83.0011b21	Shinran	Genshin	shinjin / three minds
21	three grades and single-minded nem- butsu	T2608, 83.0007a11	Daochuo	Daochuo	right / miscellaneous practices
55	entrustment / ver- ification / selection conclusion	T2608, 83.0016b22	Shinran	Daochuo	birth / Pure Land

These candidates concentrate in right / miscellaneous practices, the three grades and single-minded nembutsu, Primal Vow nembutsu, three minds / shinjin, and entrustment / verification / selection conclusion. Honen's divergence is therefore best read here not as a different meaning of nembutsu itself, but as a dense argument that selects nembutsu from among other practices.

4.8 Shinran Divergence Zones

The same score was computed for Shinran chunks. Table 12 lists the top ten.

Table12: Top Shinran-side divergence chunks

No.	Fascicle	Content zone	Start line	Nearest	Word group
162	Keshindo fascicle	protective deities and cosmic order	T2646, 83.0635b21	Genshin	birth / Pure Land
84	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0614a08	Genshin	sin / salvation
72	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0610b22	Genshin	sin / salvation
83	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0613c14	Daochuo	sin / salvation
85	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0614b02	Genshin	abandoning / establishing
71	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0610a27	Genshin	vow / transfer
182	Keshindo fascicle	critique of external teachings	T2646, 83.0640b28	Daochuo	abandoning / establishing
75	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0611b10	Daochuo	sin / salvation
74	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0611a10	Genshin	sin / salvation
78	Shin fascicle	shinjin / three minds and sin / salvation	T2646, 83.0612b05	Genshin	sin / salvation

Among the top twenty-four Shinran candidates, the Shin fascicle accounts for thirteen and the Keshindo fascicle for eight. The nearest non-self groups include Genshin, Daochuo, Tanluan, Honen, and Shandao. Shinran-side divergence therefore does not simply move away from Honen; it spreads through several patriarchal and thematic fields, especially sin / salvation in the Shin fascicle and true / provisional or external-teaching problems in the Keshindo fascicle.

4.9 Comparison of Honen and Shinran Divergence

Among the top twenty-four Honen candidates, entrustment / verification / selection conclusion appears ten times, three grades and single-minded nembutsu four times, Primal Vow nembutsu four times, three minds / shinjin three times, and right / miscellaneous practices three times. In contrast, Shinran concentrates in the Shin and Keshindo fascicles. The same notion of divergence therefore appears differently: Honen's side is a concentrated argument for selecting nembutsu, whereas Shinran's side is the expansion of a doctrinal architecture around shinjin, sin / salvation, expedient means, true / provisional sorting, and transformed land.

4.10 Representative Passage Checks

The following three examples show how the computationally extracted candidates can be returned to close reading without reproducing source text. They are selected as representative cases of Honen's selection argument, Shinran's Shin-fascicle sin / salvation problem, and Shinran's Keshindo-fascicle external-teaching or true / provisional sorting.

Table13: Representative candidate passages

Target	Location	SAT line range	Neighbor/word group	Reading point
Honen	chunk 7, right / miscellaneous practices	T2608, 0003b04	83.0003a04–nearest: Shinran; patriarch: Shandao; word group: right / miscellaneous practices	The passage is a candidate for reading Honen’s divergence as an argument that selects nem-butstu through the classification of right and miscellaneous practices.
Shinran	chunk 84, Shin fascicle	T2646, 0614b05	83.0614a08–nearest: Genshin; word group: sin / salvation	The Shin fascicle’s sin / salvation problem appears not as simple distance from Honen, but in contact with a Genshin-like thematic field.
Shinran	chunk 182, Keshindo fascicle	T2646, 0640c27	83.0640b28–nearest: Daochuo; word group: abandoning / establishing	The Keshindo fascicle’s critique of external teachings and true provisional sorting appears near a Daochuo-oriented problem field.

The first case is semantically close to Shinran but lexically concentrated in right / miscellaneous practices. The second case shows Shinran’s Shin fascicle near a Genshin-like sin / salvation field. The third case shows the Keshindo fascicle’s critique and sorting near a Daochuo-oriented field. None of these cases proves a historical relation; they are coordinates for further philological reading.

4.11 Robustness Check for the Protrusion Score

Because the protrusion score uses 2D PCA distance, it was compared with a ranking based only on high-dimensional isolation, $1 - s_i$. Table 14 summarizes the top twenty-four comparison.

Table14: Comparison of protrusion-score and high-dimensional-isolation top-24 candidates

Target	Center of top-24 protrusion-score candidates	Center of top-24 high-dimensional-isolation candidates	Overlap	Interpretation
Honen	entrustment / verification / selection conclusion 10; three grades / single-minded nembutsu 4; Primal Vow nem-butstu 4; right / miscellaneous practices 3; three minds / shinjin 3	entrustment / verification conclusion 8; three shinjin 5; right / miscellaneous practices 4; Primal Vow nembutsu 2; sacred path / Pure Land paths 2	11 chunks, J=0.297	Individual ranks change, but selection argument, entrustment / verification, and right / miscellaneous practices remain.
Shinran	Shin fascicle 13; Keshindo fascicle 8; Shin True Buddha Land fascicle 2; Realization fascicle 1	Keshindo fascicle 13; Shin fascicle 7; True Buddha Land fascicle 3; Realization fascicle 1	11 chunks, J=0.297	Ranks change, but concentration in the Shin and Keshindo fascicles remains.

The top sets do not fully match, which is expected because one ranking includes 2D PCA isolation and the other uses only the original embedding space. Even so, the broad reading remains: Honen keeps selection-argument candidates, while Shinran remains centered in the Shin and Keshindo fascicles.

5 Discussion

5.1 Scope of Interpretation

The following interpretation is restricted to what can be inferred from embedding-space arrangement, high-dimensional cosine similarity, 2D PCA protrusion, dictionary-based word groups, and source markers. The results do not replace historical scholarship. They are a map of candidate regions to be compared with doctrinal, historical, and citation-based research.

5.2 Honen Constructs the Logic of Choosing Nembutsu

In this analysis, Honen’s distinctive region is not primarily a difference in the meaning of nembutsu itself. It is the density of a classification and selection argument: why nembutsu, rather than other practices, is to be selected. This fits the form of *Senchakushu* as a work that cites sutras and Shandao in order to position vocal nembutsu as the practice for birth.

5.3 Shinran Expands Toward a Source-Based Doctrinal Architecture

Shinran keeps a region close to Honen, but spreads toward Daochuo, Genshin, Tanluan, Vasubandhu, and Shandao. Especially in the Shin and Keshindo fascicles, Honen proximity, Shinran-side protrusion candidates, and patriarchal proximity coexist. This suggests that Shinran does not merely repeat Honen, but re-replaces the nembutsu field within a larger architecture of Primal Vow, shinjin, transfer, Name, true Buddha land, transformed land, expedient means, sin and salvation, and critique of external teachings.

5.4 Significance of the Three-Layer Analysis

The semantic layer alone mixes several things: quotation, shared topic, vocabulary, and authorial exposition. A chunk near Tanluan may contain a Tanluan quotation, or Shinran’s own exposition may develop a Tanluan-like theme. The current pipeline cannot separate those cases. Keeping the semantic layer, lexical-thematic layer, and source-marker layer distinct helps avoid reading embedding proximity directly as influence or doctrinal identity.

Prior studies have addressed exclusive nembutsu, selected Primal Vow, practice and shinjin, Primal Vow transfer, true / provisional sorting, and patriarchal citation. This paper does not verify those interpretations directly. It offers a computational map of where those questions appear in the full-text distribution.

6 Limitations

1. The two PCA axes explain only about 11.6 percent of the variance, so map distances are not identical to high-dimensional proximity.
2. PCA is only one projection method. UMAP, t-SNE, and MDS have not yet been compared.
3. Fixed 700-token chunks with 100-token overlap do not match fascicle, chapter, paragraph, or quotation boundaries.
4. Fascicle and chapter labels are approximate labels based on SAT line ranges.
5. The lexical-thematic layer is dictionary-based and does not distinguish negation, speaker, context, or meaning.

6. The source-marker layer is not quotation detection. It does not separate quoted source standpoint from authorial standpoint. Comparison with quotation studies and old manuscript sutra research, including Fujiwara [11], remains necessary.
7. The interpretation is exploratory and has not been fully checked against existing scholarship for each candidate passage.
8. Manuscript variants and old manuscript traditions have not been incorporated into the analysis.

7 Conclusion

This paper mapped Honen’s *Senchakushu*, Shinran’s *Kyogyoshinsho*, and Pure Land patriarchal anchors using SAT Chinese text, Unicode-safe chunks, and `text-embedding-3-large`. Honen and Shinran strongly overlap in semantic space. The main question is what moves away from that shared core.

Honen-side divergence appears as an argument that selects nembutsu from among practices: right and miscellaneous practices, selection and rejection, Primal Vow, and entrustment or verification. Shinran-side divergence appears in the Shin fascicle’s sin / salvation problem and the Keshindo fascicle’s expedient means, true / provisional sorting, protective deities and cosmic order, and critique of external teachings. Capped-20 subsampling reduces the simple chunk-count effect, but the broad pattern remains.

Within this analysis, the difference between Honen and Shinran appears less as a difference in the meaning of nembutsu itself than as a difference in how the same nembutsu field is developed into forms of argument and source-based doctrinal architecture. This is not a replacement for existing research. It is a set of candidate regions to be tested through historical, doctrinal, and citation-based comparison.

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